

Python-Based Automated Hardware Test System Simulation

Project Report

This project simulates an automated hardware test workflow using Python. It models a Device Under Test (DUT), generates measurement readings, checks them against engineering limits, and produces a structured PASS/FAIL report in CSV format together with a final summary.

1. Objective

The objective of this project is to demonstrate realistic engineering test workflow where multiple DUTs are validated automatically. The script generates voltage, current, temperature, and sensor-output readings, applies test limits, determines overall PASS/FAIL status, and saves the results in a machine-readable report.

2. Tools Used

- Python
- Command Prompt
- CSV file generation
- Microsoft Excel
- Automated test logic
- Hardware validation concepts

3. Test Parameters

Test Parameter	Acceptable Range	Unit
Voltage	4.8 to 5.2	V
Current	0.20 to 0.60	A
Temperature	≤ 70	°C
Sensor Output	0.5 to 3.0	V

4. System Block Diagram

Python-Based Automated Hardware Test System Simulation

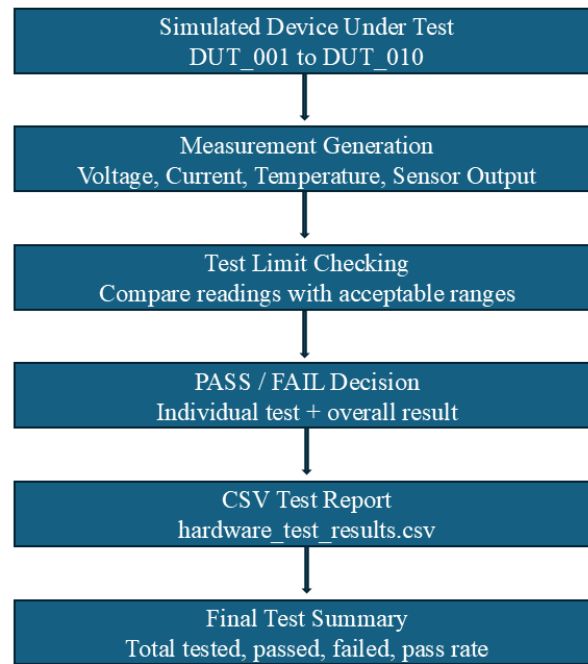


Figure 1. hardware test system block diagram.

5. Implementation

The Python script creates ten simulated DUTs (DUT_001 to DUT_010). For each DUT, it generates a voltage, current, temperature, and sensor-output reading. Each measurement is checked against predefined limits. The program then assigns PASS or FAIL to each individual test and calculates the overall result. Finally, the results are written in a CSV file, and a terminal summary is displayed.

6. Example Console Output and Summary

```
C:\Windows\System32\cmd.e x + v
Overall Result: FAIL
-----
Device ID: DUT_007
Voltage: 4.73 V -> FAIL
Current: 0.15 A -> FAIL
Temperature: 84.97 °C -> FAIL
Sensor Output: 0.72 V -> PASS
Overall Result: FAIL
-----
Device ID: DUT_008
Voltage: 4.83 V -> PASS
Current: 0.67 A -> FAIL
Temperature: 35.3 °C -> PASS
Sensor Output: 1.01 V -> PASS
Overall Result: FAIL
-----
Device ID: DUT_009
Voltage: 4.78 V -> FAIL
Current: 0.18 A -> FAIL
Temperature: 64.40 °C -> PASS
Sensor Output: 2.12 V -> PASS
Overall Result: FAIL
-----
Device ID: DUT_010
Voltage: 5.11 V -> PASS
Current: 0.15 A -> FAIL
Temperature: 48.67 °C -> PASS
Sensor Output: 2.12 V -> PASS
Overall Result: FAIL
-----
Test Summary
-----
Total Devices Tested: 10
Passed Devices: 1
Failed Devices: 9
Pass Rate: 10.0%
Fail Rate: 90.0%
-----
Test completed. Results saved to: C:\Users\kailas\OneDrive - University of Hertfordshire\Documents\hardware_test_system_simulation\results\hardware_test_results.csv
```

Figure 2. Console output showing individual DUT decisions and final test summary.

7. CSV Test Results

The CSV screenshot below shows the full test dataset with clear column names: timestamp, device_id, voltage, current, temperature, sensor_output, voltage_test, current_test, temperature_test,

sensor_test, and overall_result.

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L
	timestamp	device_id	voltage	current	temperature	sensor_output	voltage_test	current_test	temperature_test	sensor_test	overall_result	
2	15-05-2026 21:47	DUT_001	5.22	0.11	62.07	0.17	FAIL	FAIL	PASS	FAIL	FAIL	
3	15-05-2026 21:47	DUT_002	4.76	0.52	33.34	1.32	FAIL	PASS	PASS	PASS	FAIL	
4	15-05-2026 21:47	DUT_003	4.8	0.19	55.94	0.65	PASS	FAIL	PASS	PASS	FAIL	
5	15-05-2026 21:47	DUT_004	5.12	0.28	50.48	2.34	PASS	PASS	PASS	PASS	PASS	
6	15-05-2026 21:47	DUT_005	5.15	0.3	71.4	0.36	PASS	PASS	FAIL	FAIL	FAIL	
7	15-05-2026 21:47	DUT_006	4.87	0.4	78.56	1.67	PASS	PASS	FAIL	PASS	FAIL	
8	15-05-2026 21:47	DUT_007	4.73	0.15	84.97	0.72	FAIL	FAIL	FAIL	PASS	FAIL	
9	15-05-2026 21:47	DUT_008	4.83	0.67	35.3	1.01	PASS	FAIL	PASS	PASS	FAIL	
10	15-05-2026 21:47	DUT_009	4.78	0.18	64.49	2.12	FAIL	FAIL	PASS	PASS	FAIL	
11	15-05-2026 21:47	DUT_010	5.11	0.15	48.67	2.12	PASS	FAIL	PASS	PASS	FAIL	

Figure 3. CSV results opened in Excel.

8. Source Code Snapshot

```
14
15 def generate_device_readings(device_id):
16     """
17     This function simulates measurement readings from a device under test.
18
19     In real hardware testing, these values could come from:
20     - Multimeter
21     - Oscilloscope
22     - Power supply
23     - Sensor module
24     - Microcontroller serial output
25     """
26
27     voltage = round(random.uniform(4.5, 5.5), 2) # volts
28     current = round(random.uniform(0.10, 0.80), 2) # amps
29     temperature = round(random.uniform(25, 85), 2) # Celsius
30     sensor_output = round(random.uniform(0.0, 3.3), 2) # volts
31
32     return {
33         "device_id": device_id,
34         "voltage": voltage,
35         "current": current,
36         "temperature": temperature,
37         "sensor_output": sensor_output
38     }
39
40
41 def run_tests(readings):
42     """
43     This function checks whether each measurement is within the acceptable range.
44     """
```

Figure 4. Source code implementing the automated hardware test workflow.

9. Observations

- Ten devices were tested automatically.
- Only one device achieved an overall PASS result in the shown run.
- Nine devices failed because one or more measured parameters were outside the acceptable limits.
- The summary reported a pass rate of 10.0% and a fail rate of 90.0%.
- This is expected because the readings are generated randomly and the limits are intentionally strict.

10. Conclusion

This project successfully demonstrates a hardware validation workflow using Python. It shows the ability to simulate test data, apply engineering limits, produce automated PASS/FAIL decisions, save structured results, and present an end-of-test summary. The project is relevant to hardware validation,

electronics testing, embedded systems, and production test engineering.

11. Future Improvements

- Add pass/fail charts and simple analytics.
- Generate a fully automatic PDF report directly from Python.
- Store test limits in a separate configuration file.
- Add fault classification for failed devices.
- Extend the workflow to support real instruments or sensor interfaces.